

3. The following information is about hardness in water.

Hardness in water is caused by the presence of dissolved calcium (Ca^{2+}) and magnesium (Mg^{2+}) ions. These ions come from compounds that are dissolved by the water as it passes through rocks. Because they are dissolved, these ions are not removed during the water treatment processes.

Hardness in water can be identified using soap solution. The relative hardness in different water samples can be determined by measuring the volume of soap solution required to produce a given lather.

Temporary hardness in water can be removed simply by boiling. Permanent hardness can be removed by passing the sample through an ion exchange column.

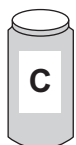
Three samples of water, **A**, **B** and **C**, were tested for hardness using soap solution. Distilled water was also tested.



Sample **A** required 8 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather before boiling.
It still required 8 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather after boiling.



Sample **B** required 12 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather before boiling.
It only required 6 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather after boiling.



Sample **C** required 15 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather before boiling.
It only required 2 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather after boiling.

Distilled water required 2 cm^3 of soap solution to form lather both before and after boiling.



- (a) Which **one** of these statements best describes the water samples before boiling? Tick (✓) the correct answer. [1]

samples **A**, **B** and **C** contain magnesium or calcium ions ☐

only samples **A** and **B** contain magnesium or calcium ions ☐

only samples **B** and **C** contain magnesium or calcium ions ☐

none of the samples contain magnesium or calcium ions ☐

- (b) What is the purpose of testing the distilled water? Tick (✓) the correct answer. [1]

to show the expected result for permanent hard water ☐

to show the expected result for temporary hard water ☐

to act as a control for the experiment ☐

to make sure the investigation is a fair test ☐

- (c) In carrying out the tests on the samples, which variables need to be kept the same each time? Tick (✓) the correct answer. [1]

volume of soap solution and number of times shaken ☐

volume of water sample and volume of soap solution used ☐

volume of water sample and number of times shaken ☐

volume of water sample, volume of soap solution and number of times shaken ☐

- (d) Which **one** of these statements best describes water sample **B**? Tick (✓) the correct answer and explain your choice. [3]

sample **B** contains temporary hardness only ☐

sample **B** contains permanent hardness only ☐

sample **B** contains a mixture of temporary and permanent hardness ☐

sample **B** does not contain hardness ☐

Explanation

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(e) In your opinion, do the advantages of living in a hard water area outweigh the disadvantages? Give **two** reasons to support your answer. [2]

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Examiner
only

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